

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 762

By Reneau

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Kay Lee Arthur of Chattanooga.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Kay Lee Arthur; and

WHEREAS, a highly respected author, teacher, and cofounder of the nonprofit ministry Precept, Mrs. Arthur worked assiduously to improve the quality of life for her fellow citizens in numerous capacities; and

WHEREAS, born in Jackson, Michigan, on November 11, 1933, Kay Arthur spent her early years moving frequently before settling in Cleveland, Ohio, where she attended nursing school at Case Western Reserve University; after earning a degree as a registered nurse, she married Tom Goetz, and the couple had two sons, Tom and Mark, before their marriage ended; and

WHEREAS, following a period of significant personal hardship, which she later described with the observation that "All suffering has an end," Mrs. Arthur experienced a deepening of the Christian faith that would shape the remainder of her professional and personal life; and

WHEREAS, Kay Arthur later studied at Tennessee Temple University in Chattanooga, where she met Tennessee Temple graduate and missionary Jack Arthur; the two were married in 1965 and, over the course of their fifty-one-year marriage, worked together in Christian service and education until Mr. Arthur's passing in 2017; and

WHEREAS, Kay and Jack Arthur served as independent missionaries in Mexico, where their son, David, was born; after leaving the mission field, they returned to Chattanooga, where Mrs. Arthur began leading Bible studies for teenagers in their living room; and

WHEREAS, what started as a small, local study group grew into Precept, a nonprofit ministry based in Chattanooga that now serves nearly 190 countries in more than 110 languages, helping people around the world engage with Scripture in a structured way; and

WHEREAS, from 1999 to 2019, Mrs. Arthur hosted Precepts for Life™, a syndicated Bible study teaching program that was broadcast to more than thirty countries and reached over seventy-five million households; the program was twice recognized as Best Television Teaching Program by the National Religious Broadcasters; and

WHEREAS, Kay Arthur's work earned national and international recognition; she was a four-time Evangelical Christian Publishers Association (ECPA) Gold Medallion Award-winning author, a recipient of ECPA's Pinnacle Award, and a recipient of both the National Religious Broadcasters Hall of Fame Award and Lifetime Achievement Award; and

WHEREAS, in acknowledgment of her contributions to Christian education and publishing, she received an honorary Doctor of Humane Letters degree from Tennessee Temple University and an honorary Doctor of Divinity degree from Piedmont International University; and

WHEREAS, even after being diagnosed with Parkinson's disease in 2020, Kay Arthur continued to be involved with Precept for as long as her health permitted, demonstrating perseverance and a sustained commitment to the mission she helped to establish; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. Arthur was deeply devoted to her family, and she always endeavored to remain true to family values of the highest order; and

WHEREAS, Kay Arthur is survived by her three sons, Tom Goetz, Mark Goetz, and David (Margaret) Arthur; nine grandchildren, Meg (John) Day, Joseph Goetz, Daniel Goetz, John (Whitney) Goetz, Ryan Goetz, Alexandra Goetz, Jesse (Zach) Callahan, Abigail (Robert) Edens, and Ann Arthur; and seven great-grandchildren; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we should pause to remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Kay Lee Arthur, reflecting fondly upon her impeccable character and her stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Mrs. Arthur.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.